



**“We have seen the fantastic job he did at NITI Aayog and what he achieved during India’s G20 presidency... He is what our Founder David Ogilvy called ‘a gentleman with brains’”**

**PIYUSH PANDEY**

CHIEF ADVISOR,  
OGILVY INDIA



**“As PM Modi’s emissary, he steered India’s G20 presidency... he not only spearheaded pivotal reforms but also left a mark on the landscape of national initiatives”**

**CHANDRAJIT BANERJEE**

DIRECTOR GENERAL, CII

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namism and always raring to go. All of them bright, brilliant and determined to succeed. Has been a real pleasure working with them...,” said one of his posts on X (formerly known as Twitter).

## A STELLAR SHERPA

Chandrajit Banerjee, Director General of trade body Confederation of Indian Industry (CII), has known Kant for years and worked closely with him during the G20. Banerjee says that as the G20 Sherpa, Kant played a pivotal role in highlighting India’s strengths, as well as the interests of the Global South.

“As PM Modi’s emissary, he steered India’s successful G20 presidency, facilitating the unanimous adoption of the ambitious New Delhi Leaders’ Declaration. He guided the CII Business20 (B20) India Secretariat in advocating for policies benefitting Indian and global businesses, while also aligning B20 objectives with broader G20 goals and priorities,” he says.

Kant’s contributions as India’s G20 Sherpa were instrumental in driving global economic collaboration and fostering inclusive and sustainable development, elevating India’s influence and leadership on the world stage, adds Banerjee. “Kant has not only spearheaded pivotal reforms but has also left an indelible mark on the landscape of national initiatives,” he notes.

A multi-faceted personality, Kant is also a regular contributor of opinion pieces in newspapers. He is also an author with a number of titles under his belt; a recent one is *Made in India: 75 years of Busi-*

*ness and Enterprise*, which came out last year and was longlisted for the 2023 Tata Literature Live! Business Book of the Year award. His latest book—co-authored with Amit Kapoor—*The Elephant Moves : India’s New Place in the World*, was released recently.

Apart from writing, he enjoys reading. He is also a keen golfer and a fitness enthusiast who spends at least an hour and a half daily on exercise. “Physical fitness is the key to mental and intellectual fitness. I believe in sweating. And I believe that every young officer must sweat and keep physically fit,” he says, adding that all young people must have one sport that they love and one extracurricular activity that they enjoy.

This also forms a part of his advice to the new generation of bureaucrats. “My advice to all UPSC aspirants is that they must read a lot and constantly keep abreast of new trends. Second, always think ahead, think of the future, and never look at the past. The past may be a guide to the future. But always think of how you want to shape the country. And third, if you are knowledgeable, if you are convinced, you should be able to work with your political masters and tell them that this is how the country needs to grow and change,” he underlines.

Pandey brilliantly sums up Kant’s personality. “He is a true gentleman. He is what our Founder David Ogilvy called ‘a gentleman with brains,’” he says. That, for you, is Amitabh Kant. **BT**

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